



Afghanistan



Great Mosque of Herat

Decorated with ornate patterned tiles, the Great Mosque has stood in the city of Herat for 800 years.

This goblet-shaped drum is made of bone, leather, metal, and wood.



Traditional drum

The beat of this zerbaghali drum is still heard in folk music played by Afghan musicians.

Kabul is a city of palaces, parks, and markets, located in a valley of the Hindu Kush Mountains.

0 100 km
0 100 miles
(approximate scale)



Lapis lazuli

This semiprecious stone has been mined in Afghanistan for more than 6,000 years. It was traded along the Silk Road and is still exported today.



Play and learn

Set up in 2007 in Kabul, Skateistan is an organization that helps children receive a good education while learning to skateboard.

Pickers inspect and pack the fruit, which is sold whole and as juice.



Crimson fruit

Afghanistan grows more varieties of pomegranates than any other country. It exports the fruit to South Asia and other regions.



- 📏 251,827 sq miles (652,230 sq km)
- 👤 36.6 million
- ★ Kabul
- 🗣️ Pashtu, Tajik, other languages (+4)

Afghanistan sits at the crossroads of **ancient trade routes**, known as the **Silk Road**, which connected Asia and Europe. **Silk, precious stones, and metals** passed through Afghan cities, bringing **great wealth**. Today, the country is known for **fruits and rugs**.